CASE STUDY · PART 1

One trusted data layer for the whole Group

How I would lead the Group BI project

BI Team Lead interview · 10 minutes

STARTING POINT

Today, 25 entities give 25 different answers to the same question

Entity 1 · ERP A

Entity 2 · ERP B

… Entity 25 · ERP C

→

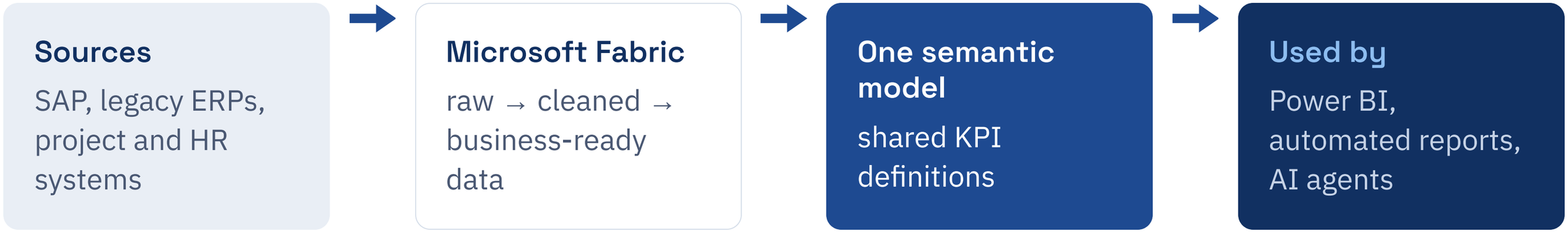
Manual consolidation in Excel

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Late, disputed numbers for management

TARGET SOLUTION

Build one shared data layer in Microsoft Fabric, not 25 reporting projects



Result: insights available on demand, no manual consolidation. Builds on today's Power BI and SQL data warehouse.

SHARED DEFINITIONS

Agree what a number means before anyone builds a report

KPI	One definition	Owner
Project delay	Forecast vs baseline milestone, in days	Project office
Project cost	Actual + committed vs budget	Group controlling
Utilisation	Project hours ÷ available hours	Operations

WHAT MANAGEMENT GETS

Each project objective becomes one automated reporting product

Objective	Reporting product	Example KPIs
Data integration	Group data layer, all entities	Entities onboarded
Operational reporting	Timeline, budget and equipment dashboard	Delay days · budget variance · equipment availability
Cost control and staffing	Running cost and utilisation report	Committed cost · utilisation %
Compliance	Access, audit and quality monitor	Open audit and quality issues

ROADMAP

Deliver in waves that follow the SAP and Fabric rollout

Months 0–3

Define

KPIs, sources, pilot entity

Months 3–6

Pilot

Project cost and delay report

Months 6–12

Scale

Entities in waves, staffing, equipment

Month 12+

Automate

Alerts and AI agents

During SAP migration: old and new data run in parallel until the numbers reconcile.

COMPLIANCE AND DATA QUALITY

Safety and regulatory controls are built into the data layer, not added later

- Access by role and entity
- Traceable numbers as evidence for safety and regulatory audits
- Automated data-quality checks
- GDPR rules for HR and timesheet data

AUTOMATION AND AI

AI agents draft the variance commentary, people approve it

1 · Data

Trusted semantic model

2 · AI agent

Finds variances, drafts comment with sources

3 · Person

Controller reviews and approves

Start with one prototype, measure accuracy, then scale.

TEAM AND WAYS OF WORKING

A small central team, one shared backlog, a champion in every entity

BI team

Business analysts and Power BI developers

→

Group Finance · KPI owners

DWH, SAP and IT · platform

Entity champions · local data

IF I START TOMORROW

First 90 days: listen, define, and deliver one quick win

Listen

Group Finance and key entities

Define

KPI dictionary and pilot scope

Deliver

First project-cost report live